GIT QUEST | 30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

Day 1: Git vs GitHub

Week 1: First Steps | Level: Absolute Beginner

Created by Rutuja Naik

Today's mission

By the end of today you will understand what Git and GitHub are, have a GitHub account, and have a public repository called **git-quest** with your first **3 commits**. No command line needed yet.

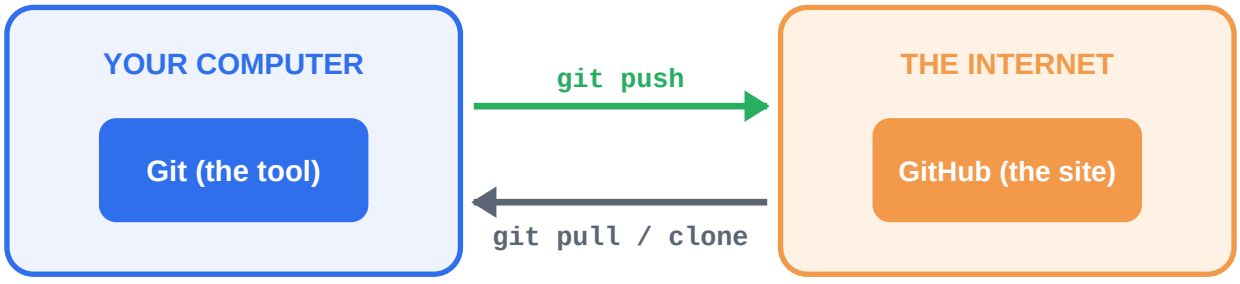
- Explain the difference between Git and GitHub in one sentence
- Install Git and check that it works
- Create your GitHub repo and make 3 commits from the browser

1. The big idea: Git is a save-game system

Imagine playing a video game that lets you save at any moment. If you make a mistake, you reload an old save. **Git does the same for your files.** Every save is called a **commit**, and each one has a short message describing what changed.

You can jump back to any save whenever you want. That is why developers are never afraid to try new things.

2. Git vs GitHub in one picture



	Git	GitHub
What is it?	A tool installed on your computer	A website that stores Git projects online
Analogy	The save-game system	Cloud storage plus a social network for your saves
Needs internet?	No, it works offline	Yes
Made by	Linus Torvalds (2005)	GitHub Inc. (owned by Microsoft)
Alternatives	None really, Git is the standard	GitLab, Bitbucket

> **Remember this one-liner**
> Git is the tool that saves your work. GitHub is the place where you share it.

3. Set up (15 minutes)

Step 1: Create a GitHub account

Go to **github.com** and sign up. Pick a username you would be happy to show an employer.

Step 2: Install Git

Windows: download from git-scm.com. **macOS:** run `brew install git` or `xcode-select --install`. **Linux:** `sudo apt install git`.

Step 3: Check that it works

Open a terminal (Git Bash on Windows) and type:

```
$ git --version
git version 2.43.0      # any recent version is fine
```

Step 4: Tell Git who you are

Git stamps your name on every commit. Run these two lines once:

```
$ git config --global user.name "Your Name"
$ git config --global user.email "you@example.com"
```

> **Tip**
> Use the same email as your GitHub account so your commits count toward your contribution graph.

Step 5: Create the repository

1. Click the **+** icon (top right) and choose **New repository**.
2. Name it `git-quest` and set it to **Public**.
3. Tick **Add a README file**, then click **Create repository**.

4. Today's 3 commits

Real terminal commits start tomorrow with `git init`. Today you will use GitHub's web editor: click **Add file > Create new file**, paste the content, and press **Commit changes**. Each save is a real commit.

#	File to create	Content	Commit message
1	day01-intro/README.md	Today's lesson: the save-game analogy and the one-liner from this PDF	docs(day01): add intro lesson on Git vs GitHub
2	README.md (edit the existing one)	Animated typing header and the Git-vs-GitHub diagram (see page 3)	feat(day01): add animated header to README
3	day01-intro/exercise.md	The challenge below plus a progress tracker in the main README	chore(day01): add exercise and progress tracker

> **Why those message prefixes?**
> `docs:` is for documentation, `feat:` for something new, `chore:` for housekeeping. Using them is a professional habit called Conventional Commits.

5. Copy-paste: animated typing header

Paste this at the top of your main README.md. GitHub will show a typewriter animation (replace the text after `lines=` with your own; use + for spaces).

```
<p align="center">
  <img src="https://readme-typing-svg.demolab.com?font=Fira+Code&size=24&pause=1000
  &color=2F6FEB&center=true&vCenter=true&width=500&lines=Welcome+to+Git+Quest;
  30+days+to+learn+Git;Day+1+is+live!" alt="Typing animation" />
</p>
```

6. Bonus: Mermaid diagram that GitHub animates for you

GitHub draws this automatically in any Markdown file. Put it inside a code block marked `mermaid`:

```
```mermaid
flowchart LR
  A[Your computer<br/>Git] -- git push --> B[GitHub<br/>cloud]
  B -- git pull --> A
```
```

7. Progress tracker for the main README

```
## Progress
| Day | Topic | Status |
|-----|-------|--------|
| 1 | Git vs GitHub | Done |
| 2 | git init and first commit | Coming soon |
| 3 | The 3 areas | Coming soon |
```

8. Challenge and quiz

Challenge: Edit your README and add one sentence in your own words explaining Git vs GitHub to a friend who has never coded. Commit it.

Quick quiz (answers at the bottom):

Q1. Which one works without internet, Git or GitHub?

Q2. What do we call a single save in Git?

Q3. Can you use Git without ever using GitHub?

Answers: 1) Git. 2) A commit. 3) Yes, GitHub is optional.

9. Optional: record a terminal GIF with VHS

Save this as `day01.tape`, install VHS, run `vhs day01.tape`, and commit both files.

```
Output day01.gif
Set FontSize 18
Set Width 900
Set Height 400
Type "git --version"
Enter
Sleep 2s
Type "echo Hello, Git Quest!"
Enter
Sleep 3s
```

Coming up: Day 2
git init and your first commit. You will create a repository on your own computer and make your first commit from the terminal. See you there!